

F TERROR



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PLAN B:
The Jeep attack
at the Glasgow
airport

THE INDIAN CONNECTION



MOHAMMED HANEEF, 27, was detained while boarding a flight out of Australia and is being interrogated by Scotland Yard's anti-terror division. Passed out of a Bangalore medical college before leaving for the UK in 2003. Moved to Australia in 2006. He is suspected of being in telephonic contact with his cousins Kafeel and Sabeel in the UK.



SABEEL AHMED, 26, another Indian doctor detained in Liverpool. He was a year senior to Haneef in Bangalore's Ambedkar Medical College and his cousin. They later worked together at the Halton Hospital in Cheshire in 2005. Has been detained by the British police for being in contact with his brother Kafeel.

"Indian Muslims have maintained a distance from extremist and jihadi activities. Hence, they have not been subjected to the same kind of intense surveillance as the members of the Pakistani diaspora. They would, therefore, be tempting assets for recruitment," says security analyst B. Raman. News of the arrests of the doctors—who swear under the Hippocratic oath to protect lives—has shaken the Indian community in Britain. "It is shocking that doctors could be connected to people trying to

kill and maim for no reason," said Dr Prasad Rao, chairman of the British International Doctors Association. Dr Ramesh Mehta, president of the British Association of Physicians of Indian Origin, urged Indian doctors not to panic. "He (Haneef) is only a suspect, he hasn't been found guilty yet. In any case, this could simply be a one-off episode. The British public knows that Indian doctors have given them sterling service for the past 30 years," he said.

British authorities have already begun reviewing recruitment of over-

seas medical staff and expanding lists for terrorists. New agreements are being sought with countries around the world to ensure a coordinated response to the terrorist threat. There are 27,558 Indian doctors registered on the National Health Service (NHS) and with British Prime Minister Gordon Brown announcing extra checks on foreign doctors, the spotlight may turn to Indian doctors. "This is a macabre, kind of reverse outsourcing from Bangalore," shrugs a top Bangalore police official investigating the case. "Earlier we were exporting techies, but this unwarranted Indian link with terrorism has put the city in a different spotlight now." The London plot puts a new terrorist in the limelight—self-motivated, trained and radicalised, who lacks the military or bomb-making skills of his predecessors as the rather amateurish execution of the plot shows. But the cells are difficult to penetrate and tough to dismantle. The credentials of these "Do-It-Yourself" recruits do not show up on regular anti-terror scanners.

The three Indian doctors—Kafeel, Sabeel and Haneef—were related and left to work in NHS hospitals in 2003 in and around UK. Haneef had moved to Brisbane last year and, according to police sources, was in mobile and e-mail contact with Sabeel and Kafeel in the run up to the bombings. He was arrested at Brisbane airport on July 2 shortly before boarding a flight to Bangalore and is being interrogated by Scotland Yard's anti-terror unit.

Australian employer Queensland Health Services said he had applied for leave only on Monday. There were other evidences at his top floor rented flat on the Gold Coast, indicating it was a last minute trip. Australian police, who raided it, found unwashed dishes in the sink, washings hanging in the balcony and his laptop missing. The young Indian doctor had told his colleagues in the Gold Coast Hospital that he was anxious to return to India to meet his wife and child. Dr Ali, his friend and colleague, who was also detained and later let off, lived barely 400 yards away from his house. Both had earlier worked together in a hospital in Liverpool.

How did Haneef—described as "sober, intelligent and very polite" by